

BOOKLESSS — INTERNAL

Roles for Growth

Who to hire, when, and how to align each person with the platform's future

May 2026

THE APPROACH

Hiring Philosophy

Every person who works on this platform should have a direct financial reason to make it succeed. No flat salaries at this stage — every role is structured around commission, revenue share, or royalties. This keeps costs variable while the platform is growing and means the people doing the work are running the same calculation you are: more students, better retention, stronger content.

Costs stay purely variable until monthly revenue reaches K10,000. After that, selected roles can move to a hybrid structure. Until then, if the platform doesn't earn, nobody earns.

Hire milestone-gated, not time-gated. The question is not 'when do we hire?' — it is 'what revenue level unlocks each role?'

SEQUENCE

When to Hire Each Role

The six roles below are ordered by priority. Each one addresses a specific bottleneck in the platform. Don't hire ahead of the bottleneck — the role won't have enough to do.

Priority	Role	Unlocks when...
1	Campus Representative	You have a free trial offer and no time to recruit yourself
2	Community Host	You have 10+ active students and discussions need a daily steward
3	Course Author	You want to launch a 4th course without writing it yourself
4	Operations & Collections Lead	You're manually chasing 15+ renewals per month
5	Growth Lead	The WhatsApp funnel needs full-time attention to convert at scale
6	Curriculum Strategist	You have 3+ active courses and the roadmap needs a dedicated owner

ROLE 01

Campus Representative

Campus Reps are students at target universities — UNZA, CBU, Mulungushi — who recruit their classmates. They know the courses, they know the pain points, and they have the peer trust that a flyer or a WhatsApp message from a stranger doesn't. First target: one Rep at UNZA, one at CBU.

What they own

- Identify classmates sitting relevant courses and introduce them to the free trial
- Share lead magnets in course WhatsApp groups and study circles
- Follow up on warm leads and walk trial students through joining Slack
- Report conversion numbers monthly

Compensation

K100 per referred student who completes their first paid month

K50 / month per active referred student while they remain subscribed

Example: 10 active referrals ? K500 / month ongoing

The ongoing K50 tail is the key design choice. A Rep who sends low-quality leads — students who try once and leave — earns less than one who sends students who stay. They stop earning the moment a referral churns.

ROLE 02

Community Host

The Community Host owns the Slack channels for one course. Their job is to make the community feel alive — starting discussions, answering questions, welcoming new members, and running a weekly prompt tied to the current lesson. First hire: one Host for Treasury Management, the most active course.

What they own

- Daily presence in the course channels (minimum one post per weekday)
- Weekly discussion prompt linked to the current lesson step
- Welcoming new students within 48 hours of them joining
- Flagging students who go quiet for more than two weeks

Compensation

K300 / month base

K30 per monthly active user (MAU) in their channels above 10

Example: 25 MAU ? $K300 + (15 \times K30) = K750$ / month

The MAU bonus means the Host earns more only if students stay engaged. Their job is retention, not just posting — the compensation is designed to make that obvious.

ROLE 03

Course Author

Course Authors write the lesson steps for a single course. They are subject matter experts — typically graduates or final-year students who scored well in that paper. They own the accuracy of the content and update it when syllabi change. First hire: one Author for a 4th course, most likely Financial Accounting or Business Finance.

What they own

- Write all 10 lesson steps following the Bookless PDF design system
- Maintain content accuracy and update steps when the syllabus changes
- Coordinate with the Curriculum Strategist on the editorial calendar

Compensation

K500 per lesson step delivered and approved (10 steps = K5,000 on completion)

8% monthly royalty on revenue from students enrolled in their course

Example: 20 students × K250 / month = K5,000 course revenue ? K400 royalty / month

The royalty means an Author earns more if students stay subscribed. They are incentivised to write content that helps students pass — not just content that looks polished on delivery day. Bad content drives churn, and churn cuts their royalty.

ROLE 04

Operations & Collections Lead

This role handles the financial plumbing: tracking MoMo payments, managing the revenue log, following up on renewals at day 25, and flagging students who have lapsed without cancelling. Part-time to start. One person can handle this up to around 60 active students.

What they own

- Log all payments in the revenue log within 24 hours of receipt
- Send renewal reminders at day 25 of each student's billing cycle

- Flag and follow up on unpaid accounts via WhatsApp
- Deliver a monthly financial summary to the founder

Compensation

K200 flat per month while total collected revenue is under K3,000

5% of all revenue collected above K3,000 / month

Example: K8,000 collected ? $K200 + (5\% \times K5,000) = K450$ / month

ROLE 05

Growth Lead

The Growth Lead runs the WhatsApp marketing operation — distributing lead magnets, managing group conversations, and moving prospects from first contact to free trial sign-up. Part-time initially, with a clear path to full-time once the funnel is converting consistently.

What they own

- Distribute lead magnets across target university WhatsApp groups
- Manage warm conversations and answer questions about the platform
- Drive free trial sign-ups and hand new trials off to the Community Host
- Track funnel numbers monthly: leads contacted, trials started, conversions

Compensation

K150 per free trial activation they drive

K300 bonus per trial that converts to a paid plan within 30 days

Example: 10 trials, 4 convert ? $(10 \times K150) + (4 \times K300) = K2,700$ / month

Two payments — one for the trial, one for the conversion — separate volume from quality. A Growth Lead who floods the funnel with unqualified contacts earns the K150 once and nothing more. One who sends serious students earns K450 per head.

ROLE 06 — THE FUTURE-THINKING ROLE

Curriculum Strategist

The Curriculum Strategist decides which courses Bookless adds next. They research syllabi at UNZA, CBU, and Mulungushi, talk to students and lecturers, commission Course Authors, and own the content roadmap. This is the role where short-term thinking is actively punished by the incentive structure.

What they own

- Identify and vet the next 2–3 courses to build, ranked by student demand
- Commission Course Authors and hold them to the content standard
- Monitor university exam calendars and adjust the roadmap accordingly
- Decide when to retire or update courses as syllabi change

Compensation

No base salary

12% royalty on all revenue from courses they greenlight

Vesting: 1% per month over 12 months from the course launch date

If a course is killed before 12 months: vesting stops, accrued royalties are paid

Example: course at K4,000 / month in month 8 ? 8% vested ? K320 / month

Why the 12-month vest creates the right thinking:

A strategist on a vesting royalty will only greenlight courses with genuine, durable demand. Before saying yes to a new course, they have to ask: Will UNZA still offer this in two years? Does this paper have three exam sittings per year or just one? Is the student population large enough to generate meaningful revenue? These are questions that only matter if you are thinking 12 months out — which is exactly the point. The royalty vest means they stay engaged through the full launch arc. They collect nothing if the course dies in month three.

First hire note: the founder holds this role for the first 12 months. Only bring in an external Strategist once 3+ active courses are running and the pattern is clear enough to hand off with confidence.

REFERENCE

Compensation at a Glance

Role	Base	Variable	Variable trigger
Campus Representative	—	K100 + K50/mo per referral	Per paid student referred
Community Host	K300/mo	K30 per MAU above 10	Monthly active users
Course Author	K500/step	8% royalty on course rev.	Students enrolled in course
Ops & Collections	K200/mo *	5% above K3,000	Revenue collected
Growth Lead	—	K150/trial + K300 on convert	Trials driven and converted
Curriculum Strategist	—	12% royalty, 12-mo vest	Revenue from greenlights

* Ops base applies only while monthly collected revenue is under K3,000.

CLOSING

Hire From Your Students First

Every one of these roles can be filled by someone already inside the Bookless community. A student who scored a distinction in Treasury Management is a stronger candidate for Course Author than a graduate who has never used the platform. A student who refers three classmates before you even ask is your first Campus Rep. Watch who shows up, helps others, and cares about the outcomes — then give them the title and the economics to match.

Hiring externally is a last resort when the community doesn't produce the right candidate. Post to your existing students before posting anywhere else.